



February 28th 2017 Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e67DxK6LOFc
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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: February 28, 2017

Time: 9:00 AM

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order at [00:00:00](#) by Council President Ron (Presiding Officer). Opening ceremonies included the Pledge of Allegiance led by Mayor Gwendoff [00:00:15](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Dr. Alexander, Mr. Janger, Mr. Madsen, Mr. Piper, Mr. Clayton, Mr. Blitzer, Mr. Chambers, and Ms. Lasseter (Note: Full roll call conducted at [00:00:53](#)).
 - *Presiding Officer:* Council President Ron.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:15](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the January 24, 2017 meeting were approved (motion moved by Scott, seconded by Jane; roll call vote administered) [00:01:06](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:40 Financial Agenda: Family Support Division**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Family Support Division representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The division initially requested \$5,000 for a deputy prosecutor. The representative withdrew the request to submit a major adjustment next month, proposing a revised amount of \$1,525.06 to cover the 90-day starting salary adjustment (bringing the base pay up to parity with other deputy prosecutors) using funds from the council's salary adjustment account.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Request withdrawn for modification.
- **00:07:00 Financial Agenda: Auditor (Publication Costs & Tax Sales)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Janet Kessler, Tax Sales Deputy.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Total request of \$23,500 (\$6,500, \$9,000, and \$8,000 components) for publication costs. Funded entirely by collected tax sale fees (\$25 per parcel; \$37,653 collected last year).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (moved by Chris, seconded by Mary).
- **00:08:45 Financial Agenda: Health Insurance (Fund 1121)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$60,965.24 for health insurance appropriations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott, seconded by Larry).
- **00:09:28 Financial Agenda: EMS Capital Improvement Fund (Mobile Data Terminals)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason (EMS Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$35,000 from capital improvements to replace Panasonic Toughbook computers (CF-19s) that are past end-of-life. EMS is piggybacking on the Sheriff's Department and City Police quote to purchase G-TAC F1-10 touch-screen mobile data terminals (rugged, iPad-like units with docking stations) for transport ambulances and squads.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott, seconded by Jane).
- **00:12:43 Financial Agenda: Highway Department (Street Brooms & Radios)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Total request of \$185,057.33 (\$60,000 for a street broom; \$125,057.33 for radios). The superintendent explained the six-year-old broom is worn out. The radio expenditure is mandatory because the old analog radio frequency was shut down/upgraded by the state to a digital P25 public safety system, completely cutting out public works communications.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Chris, seconded by Scott).
- **00:20:35 Financial Agenda: Public Safety Health Insurance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Donna Patterson.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$100,000 as a one-time allocation to cover health insurance needs for sheriff's correctional officers, utilizing excess operating balances.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott, seconded by Jessica).
- **00:22:39 Financial Agenda: Elected Officials Training Fund**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Treasurer's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$2,000 for schooling/training.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Jessica, seconded by Scott).
- **00:23:10 Financial Agenda: Auditor Support Imaging & Equipment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request of \$6,991.88 (\$5,000 for support imaging/GIS contribution split across two years, and \$1,991.88 for furniture and equipment).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott, seconded by Jessica).
- **00:24:14 Financial Agenda: Major Transfer (Treasurer to Sheriff)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department / Maggie.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$480 from Chief Deputy Treasurer (-\$480) to Receptionist (+\$480) for a new Sheriff's Department receptionist salary role.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Chris).
- **00:25:40 Financial Agenda: Commissioners Office Manager Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners' Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$325.29 for the office manager position.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Jane, seconded by Scott).
- **00:26:55 Financial Agenda: Health Insurance Supplement (Various Line Reductions)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Donna Patterson.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer utilizing 2016 unspent balances to fund health insurance (\$95,171) by reducing line items in FICA (-\$25,000), telephone (-\$20,000), supplies (-\$25,000), and utilities (-\$25,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:27:57 Financial Agenda: Circuit Court Staff Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Internal promotion following a resignation. Court Secretary promoted to Assistant Court Reporter, and a new Court Secretary hired. Net zero financial request.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott, seconded by Jessica).
- **00:29:19 Financial Agenda: Community Corrections Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Community Corrections.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net zero transfers across supervisor, surveillance officer, and administrative assistant lines to employment and office equipment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott, seconded by Jane).
- **00:30:43 Financial Agenda: Communication Center & Jail New Hires/Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communication Center / Jail.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Net zero salary transfers for communication tech and correctional officer positions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott, seconded by Chris).
- **00:31:54 Financial Agenda: Jail Health Insurance vs. Hospital Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$25,000 from unused hospital services line to health insurance claims.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott, seconded by Larry).
- **00:33:16 Financial Agenda: Highway Department Title Change/Upgrade**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Upgrading a truck driver position to an equipment operator (\$29,163.56 net zero transfer) to support paving and road project operations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (moved by Jane, seconded by Jessica).
- **00:35:52 Financial Agenda: Auditor Office Salary Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following an upcoming retirement of the insurance deputy, reducing that line by \$1,500 and distributing \$750 each to the claims deputy and tax sale deputy to establish salary parity and reflect increased cross-trained responsibilities following a staff reduction of six full-time positions.
 - **Note:** Council members Lasseter and Clayton voted "No," voicing concerns that salary restructuring should occur during regular budget cycles rather than via mid-year transfers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (with dissenting votes recorded).
- **00:46:30 Ordinance 2017-103: Authorizing Crime Insurance Policy**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Legal Counsel Mr. Hughes.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance authorizing the Board of Commissioners to purchase a crime insurance policy, complying with a new state statute effective July

1st of the prior year. (Introduced previously; presented for second reading).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as a second reading by Roll Call Vote (moved by Larry, seconded by Scott).
 - **00:48:42 Ordinance 2017-105: Defining Terms and Establishing Hiring/Salary Procedures**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President Ron / Legal Counsel Mr. Hughes.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance consolidating approximately 12 disparate historical ordinances governing county hiring, salary implementation, and procedures (excluding merit officers). It establishes clear job grading, human resources oversight, and formalizes county handbook policies while curbing unauthorized departmental salary modifications. Department heads will be required to verify budget/line item clearance through the council before hiring.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved on First Reading by Roll Call Vote (moved by Scott).
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:10:51 Jeff Arnold (Delaware County resident):** Addressed the council regarding state legislation concerning county needle exchange (which he characterized as a government “needle giveaway” program, displaying sample kits distributed in Madison County containing cookers, alcohol swabs, tourniquets, and clean syringes). He cited statistics on the opioid epidemic, rising overdose rates, pharmacy robberies, and drug-driven crime in Indiana, urging the council and community to stay ahead of the issue and avoid enabling illicit drug use.
 - **01:19:51 Sheriff (Ray / County Officials):** Spoke regarding the local impacts of drug addiction on law enforcement, homicides, and jail populations. Noted that the Sheriff’s Department recently equipped deputies with Narcan (via the health department) to save overdose victims, but expressed strong opposition to needle giveaway programs. Highlighted ongoing collaborative efforts with community leaders to establish a secure, court-ordered residential drug treatment facility with long-term back-end services.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Commissioners announced plans to begin filming council meetings.
 - Announcement regarding the upcoming Delaware County Farm Fest at the fairgrounds (March 14-15), featuring agricultural displays and community meals.
 - Notice that a replacement representative needs to be appointed to the Yorktown Library board.

- Redevelopment commission update provided regarding recent regional meetings and officer elections (Martin Moody elected vice president).
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made and approved by voice vote at the conclusion of the meeting [01:37:01](#).
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